



Taberna Salinas inexpensive

Calle de Elvira 13; www.tabernassalinas.com

Widely known for offering high quality at low prices, Salinas proffers tapas that are scaled-down versions of full recipe dishes: scrambled eggs with ham and fried potatoes, broad beans simmered with little pieces of ham, or beef braised with sweet peppers.

Cunini Restaurante & Marisquería moderate

Plaza de Pescadería 14; +34 958 250 777

Appropriately for its location on the fishmongers' square, Cunini serves the best seafood tapas in Granada. Salt cod dishes or calamari are common first offerings – it could take three drinks before they bring out the shrimp or crisply fried mullet.



NEW YORK CITY

Following the Spanish Civil War, thousands of Spaniards fled to New York, and many made their homes in Manhattan's Chelsea neighborhood. Few restaurants from that era remain, but New York has blossomed with contemporary tapas restaurants.

Boqueria moderate

53 West 19th Street; www.boquerianyc.com

Named for the famous Barcelona market, Boqueria ranges across Spain for its tapas, from the classic potato omelet to bacon-wrapped dates stuffed with almonds and blue cheese and a Catalan sauté of spinach, garbanzos, pine nuts, garlic, and raisins.

Txikito moderate

240 Ninth Avenue; www.txikitonyc.com

Serving mostly Basque wines with its *pintxos* (as the Basques call tapas), Txikito pays homage to Spanish Basque cookery with dishes such as blistered peppers with sea salt, or a salad of Basque anchovies and bonito tuna on butter lettuce.

LONDON, UK

The English love affair with vacations in sunny Spain has translated into a boom in Spanish restaurants, especially in London's Soho and Bloomsbury areas. Most offer extensive tapas menus and a strong list of Spanish wines.

Navarro's inexpensive

67 Charlotte Street, W1; www.navarros.co.uk

With a menu (and wine list) more redolent of northern than southern Spain, the tapas at Navarro's

are rib-sticking and satisfying – like the Galician tuna *empanada* (stuffed pastry), braised oxtail, and lentil stew with chorizo. Its red wine choices are splendid.

Barrafina moderate

54 Frith Street, W1; www.barrafina.co.uk

An intimate room with about two dozen stools around a counter, Barrafina has the crowd density to claim Spanish authenticity and the menu to match, from grilled bread smeared with tomato and olive oil to grilled quail with aioli.

Tapas Brindisa moderate

18–20 Southwark Street, SE1; www.brindisa.com

The south London tapas bar of a famous Spanish food importer, Brindisa always has just the ingredients on hand for top-notch, authentic tapas like thin slices of *jamón ibérico*, intensely spicy León chorizo, and the incomparable canned anchovies of Galicia.

SYDNEY, AUSTRALIA

Although the expansion of Chinatown has nearly absorbed the old Spanish Quarter along Liverpool Street in central Sydney, Spanish tapas restaurants and bars are sprouting up all over the city as dining-by-the-nibble catches on.

Bodega inexpensive

216 Commonwealth Street, Surry Hills; www.bodegatapas.com

With a tapas menu that travels beyond Spain to embrace Latin America, Bodega serves authentic Spanish dishes like salt-cod-stuffed *piquillo* peppers and Argentine plates like beef *empanadas* with *criolla* sauce. The short, sweet dessert list is also a big hit.

Kika moderate

247 Victoria Street, Darlinghurst; www.kika.com.au

The color splashes of this dynamic tapas bar could have been lifted from an early Pedro Almodóvar film, but dishes like deep-fried eggplant in parsley batter or barbecued pork fillets with blue cheese come straight from rustic Spanish cuisine.

El Toro Loco expensive

49–53 North Steyne, Manly; www.eltoroloco.com.au

The Crazy Bull is as bold as its name, bringing authentic Spanish cooking to Manly Beach with tapas like Jerez-style duck pâté, Madrid-style *cocido*, and Castilian lamb cutlets char-grilled with rosemary. Wines are a great mix of Spanish and Australian.

